

D759

Elementary Literacy and Mathematics Strategies and Assistive Technologies

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer _____	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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Items

1.

A third grader's IEP has a reading fluency goal. The resource room, which was repainted over the summer, has a new bookshelf of leveled readers. The teacher wants a weekly check that shows whether the student is on track. Which plan fits curriculum-based measurement?

- A.** The unit test at the end of each reading unit.
- B.** A one-minute probe each week using whatever leveled reader the student picks from the shelf.
- C.** A full diagnostic reading battery every week.
- D.** A one-minute oral reading probe each week from a set of passages of equal difficulty, with scores graphed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher sees a student's weekly CBM scores jump up and down by large amounts. She learns that each week she pulled a passage from a different grade-level book. What is the most likely problem?

- A.** The student needs a different IEP goal.
- B.** Weekly probes are always too frequent to be useful.
- C.** The probes were not equivalent forms, so score changes reflect passage difficulty, not growth.
- D.** The student has a behavior problem during testing.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A second grader with a learning disability solves two-digit addition with regrouping using base-ten blocks every time. On a worksheet of the same problems she guesses. Her class uses a popular online math game on Fridays, and her family recently moved. What should the teacher do next?

- A.** Assign more time on the Friday online math game.
- B.** Take away the blocks and assign more worksheet practice.
- C.** Go back to counting single cubes by ones.
- D.** Have her draw quick sketches of tens and ones to solve problems before moving to numbers only.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A fourth grader with a reading disability reads grade-level text at 95% accuracy but only 58 words correct per minute, in a flat, word-by-word way. He loves books about sharks and has a new puppy at home. Which intervention best fits this profile?

- A. Beginning phonemic awareness lessons on rhyming.
- B. Timed reading of new passages that are two grade levels higher.
- C. Twenty extra minutes of silent independent reading of shark books.
- D. Repeated reading of short instructional-level passages with modeling and feedback.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher wants to use repeated reading. Which student is the poorest match for it as the main intervention?

- A. A student who reads accurately and slowly and also needs extra practice time.
- B. A student who reads 70% of words correctly and cannot sound out short-vowel words.
- C. A student who reads accurately but slowly.
- D. A student who reads accurately but without expression.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

A first grader with dyslexia keeps mixing up the sounds for b and d. His classroom has a large window that faces the playground, and his teacher just finished a unit on seasons. Which activity reflects multisensory structured literacy?

- A. He reads leveled books silently until the confusion fades on its own.
- B. He colors a worksheet of seasonal pictures that start with b.
- C. He says the sound /b/ while tracing a large b on a textured surface and naming a key word.
- D. He watches a video song about the alphabet.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A special education teacher co-teaches a fifth-grade math block of 26 students. Students can name the steps of a word-problem strategy on a poster but cannot use them on new problems. The school recently adopted a new math series. What should she do first?

- A. Tell students to think about their thinking as they work.
- B. Solve a problem in front of them, saying aloud each decision and check she makes.
- C. Have students memorize the poster steps for a quiz.
- D. Wait until the new math series provides its own strategy.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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8.

An IEP team is choosing a writing support for a second grader with fine-motor delays who tires after a sentence of handwriting. The district just bought tablets for every grade, and the student's older sister uses a laptop. Using a SETT-style process, what should the team do first?

- A. Look at the student's needs, the classroom setting, and the writing tasks, then trial simple options such as a pencil grip and slant board before high-tech tools.
- B. Replace writing tasks with oral answers for the rest of the year.
- C. Assign a tablet with speech-to-text since the district already bought them.
- D. Always choose the most advanced device so the student will not need a change later.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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9. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student has used a simple pencil grip for six weeks. Data show he still writes only two legible words a minute and falls far behind in every writing task. What does the AT process call for now?

- A. Keep the pencil grip because low-tech is always preferred.
- B. Trial a more supportive tool, such as a keyboard or word prediction, and collect data again.
- C. Lower the writing IEP goal to two words a minute.
- D. Stop using any support until he writes faster.

Target word _____	The one fact that decides _____	Answer ___	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
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10.

A third grader with a reading disability has an IEP goal to decode two-syllable words. During science, a unit with a colorful field guide and a visit from a park ranger, she uses text-to-speech to read the lesson. Her teacher suggests also using text-to-speech during her daily decoding lesson. What is the best response?

- A.** Keep text-to-speech for science content but not in the decoding lesson, where she must read the words herself.
- B.** Replace the field guide with a simpler book so she needs no tools.
- C.** Use text-to-speech everywhere so she never struggles.
- D.** Stop text-to-speech in science too, so she practices decoding all day.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student reads at a first-grade level and is in fourth grade. His IEP includes a social studies goal to explain causes of historical events. Which support best serves that goal?

- A.** No support, because tools always slow reading growth.
- B.** Removing the social studies goal until he reads at grade level.
- C.** Text-to-speech for the grade-level social studies text.
- D.** First-grade decodable books about unrelated topics.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A second-grade teacher with a class of 24, including four students with IEPs, wants more reading practice time. She has a student teacher on Tuesdays and a new rug for the reading corner. Which plan reflects peer-assisted learning strategies?

- A.** Pairs take turns as coach and reader using a taught script, with correction steps, several times a week.
- B.** Have the student teacher read aloud on the new rug on Tuesdays.
- C.** Pair each student with an IEP with the best reader and tell them to help.
- D.** Let students choose any partner and any book each day.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A third grader's IEP has a reading fluency goal. The resource room, ~~which was repainted over the summer, has a new bookshelf of leveled readers.~~ The teacher wants a weekly check that shows whether the student is on track. Which plan fits curriculum-based measurement?

Target word: which progress-monitoring plan is CBM **Decides:** CBM = brief, equivalent, repeated probes graphed over time.

A	Adjacent category	Unit tests measure mastery of that unit, not steady growth toward a general outcome.
B	Camouflage	Uses the new bookshelf; passages of different difficulty make the trend meaningless.
C	Confusion set	Diagnostic tests locate skill gaps; they are too long to give weekly and are not progress monitors.
D	Correct	Brief, standardized, equivalent forms given often is the defining CBM design.

2. Answer C Concept 1 • transfer

A teacher sees a student's weekly CBM scores jump up and down by large amounts. She learns that each week she pulled a passage from a different grade-level book. What is the most likely problem?

Target word: why the CBM data are unreliable **Decides:** Probes were not of equal difficulty.

A	Inverted operation	Changes the goal to fit bad data instead of fixing the measure.
B	Absolute language	Weekly probing is standard for students in intensive support.
C	Correct	CBM depends on equivalent probes; otherwise the graph tracks the passage.
D	Adjacent category	Possible, but the stem points to changing passage difficulty as the cause.

3. Answer D Concept 2

A second grader with a learning disability solves two-digit addition with regrouping using base-ten blocks every time. On a worksheet of the same problems she guesses. ~~Her class uses a popular online math game on Fridays, and her family recently moved.~~ What should the teacher do next?

Target word: next CRA step **Decides:** She succeeds at concrete but fails at abstract: bridge with the representational stage.

A	Camouflage	The game is irrelevant detail; it does not bridge concrete to abstract.
B	Dropped element	Skips the representational stage she needs to link objects to symbols.
C	Inverted operation	Moves backward past a stage she has already mastered.
D	Correct	Representational drawings bridge the gap between blocks and symbols.

4. Answer D Concept 3

A fourth grader with a reading disability reads grade-level text at 95% accuracy but only 58 words correct per minute, in a flat, word-by-word way. ~~He loves books about sharks and has a new puppy at home.~~ Which intervention best fits this profile?

Target word: intervention for accurate but slow reading **Decides:** Accuracy is adequate; rate and phrasing are low.

A	Adjacent category	His 95% accuracy shows phonemic and decoding skills are not the main gap.
B	Wrong stem number	Frustration-level text undercuts accuracy; practice should be at instructional level.
C	Camouflage	Uses his interest but gives no feedback or modeling; silent reading does not build fluency for struggling readers.
D	Correct	Repeated reading targets rate and prosody once decoding is accurate.

5. Answer B Concept 3 · transfer

A teacher wants to use repeated reading. Which student is the poorest match for it as the main intervention?

Target word: who does NOT fit repeated reading **Decides:** Repeated reading assumes basic decoding is in place.

A	Dropped element	Extra practice time does not rule out repeated reading; decoding is intact.
B	Correct	A decoding gap must be taught directly first; rereading guessed words builds errors.
C	Confusion set	This is the ideal repeated-reading profile.
D	Adjacent category	Prosody is a fluency part that repeated reading with modeling improves.

6. Answer C Concept 4

A first grader with dyslexia keeps mixing up the sounds for b and d. ~~His classroom has a large window that faces the playground, and his teacher just finished a unit on seasons.~~ Which activity reflects multisensory structured literacy?

Target word: which activity is multisensory structured literacy **Decides:** Linking sight, sound, and movement at the same time in explicit instruction.

A	Dropped element	Drops explicit instruction; reversals do not reliably resolve with exposure alone.
B	Camouflage	Borrows the seasons unit; coloring does not link sound to letter formation.
C	Correct	Seeing, saying, and tracing together ties the symbol to its sound.
D	Adjacent category	Engaging, but passive and not systematic sound-symbol practice.

7. Answer B Concept 5

A special education teacher co-teaches a fifth-grade math block ~~of 26 students.~~ Students can name the steps of a word-problem strategy on a poster but cannot use them on new problems. ~~The school recently adopted a new math series.~~ What should she do first?

Target word: how to make a strategy usable **Decides:** Students know the steps but have not seen them used.

A	Dropped element	An instruction with no model leaves the thinking invisible.
B	Correct	A think-aloud shows what the strategy looks like in real use.
C	Inverted operation	They already know the names; memorizing more does not build use.
D	Camouflage	The new series does not decide how to teach strategy use.

8. Answer A Concept 6

An IEP team is choosing a writing support for a second grader with fine-motor delays who tires after a sentence of handwriting. ~~The district just bought tablets for every grade, and the student's older sister uses a laptop.~~ Using a SETT-style process, what should the team do first?

Target word: first step in AT selection **Decides:** Match the student, environment, and task; try simplest tools that meet the need.

A	Correct	SETT starts from student, environment, and task and tries the least complex tool that works.
B	Adjacent category	That is a modification of the task, not an AT decision.
C	Camouflage	Availability of tablets does not decide fit.
D	Absolute language	More complex is not better; the match to need decides.

9. Answer B Concept 6 · transfer

A student has used a simple pencil grip for six weeks. Data show he still writes only two legible words a minute and falls far behind in every writing task. What does the AT process call for now?

Target word: when to move up the AT continuum **Decides:** Data show the simple tool is not meeting the need.

A	Absolute language	Low-tech first is a starting point, not a rule to keep a tool that fails.
B	Correct	When the simple tool fails on data, the team moves up the continuum and re-checks.
C	Adjacent category	Changes the goal instead of the tool.
D	Inverted operation	Removes support right when need is clearest.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A third grader with a reading disability has an IEP goal to decode two-syllable words. During science, ~~a unit with a colorful field guide and a visit from a park ranger,~~ she uses text-to-speech to read the lesson. Her teacher suggests also using text-to-speech during her daily decoding lesson. What is the best response?

Target word: where text-to-speech belongs **Decides:** The decoding lesson targets the skill text-to-speech bypasses.

A	Correct	TTS provides access to content; it would remove the practice the decoding goal requires.
B	Camouflage	The field guide detail does not decide where TTS fits.
C	Absolute language	Removing all struggle removes decoding practice.
D	Inverted operation	Denies access to grade-level science content she is entitled to.

11. Answer C Concept 7 · transfer

A student reads at a first-grade level and is in fourth grade. His IEP includes a social studies goal to explain causes of historical events. Which support best serves that goal?

Target word: when text-to-speech is the right tool **Decides:** The goal is content understanding, not decoding.

A	Absolute language	Access tools do not block decoding growth when decoding is taught separately.
B	Inverted operation	Withholds content learning until reading catches up, the opposite of access.
C	Correct	When the goal is content, TTS removes the decoding barrier without undercutting the target skill.
D	Adjacent category	Decoding practice matters, but it does not give access to the social studies content the goal names.

12. Answer A Concept 8

A second-grade teacher with a class of 24, including four students with IEPs, wants more reading practice time. ~~She has a student teacher on Tuesdays and a new rug for the reading corner.~~ Which plan reflects peer-assisted learning strategies?

Target word: what makes peer tutoring PALS **Decides:** Trained, reciprocal roles with a set routine.

A	Correct	Structured, reciprocal roles and scripts define PALS.
B	Camouflage	Uses the staffing detail; teacher read-aloud is not peer practice.
C	Dropped element	No training, script, or role switching.
D	Adjacent category	Free partner reading lacks structure and feedback.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owled.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	1	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	9	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	6	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	CBM as a progress monitor	Curriculum-based measurement uses brief, standardized, equivalent probes given often (weekly) so the trend shows whether instruction is working.	Using end-of-unit tests or different-difficulty passages as the progress measure.	“How should the teacher check each week whether the student is growing?”
2	Concrete-representational-abstract (CRA)	Math concepts move from hands-on objects to drawings to numbers and symbols, and a student drops back a stage when the abstract step fails.	Starting with the algorithm and adding manipulatives only as a reward or game.	A student can do it with blocks but not on paper, or the reverse.
3	Repeated reading for fluency	Rereading the same instructional-level passage several times with feedback builds accuracy and rate that transfer to new text.	Assigning more silent independent reading to a student who reads slowly and inaccurately.	A student decodes accurately but slowly and choppy.
4	Multisensory structured literacy	Sound-symbol links are taught explicitly and in sequence while the student sees, says, and writes or traces them at the same time.	Thinking multisensory means adding fun activities rather than linking sound, symbol, and movement in one step.	A student with dyslexia keeps confusing letter-sound pairs.
5	Think-aloud for metacognitive strategies	The teacher makes an invisible thinking process visible by saying aloud what a skilled reader or solver notices and decides.	Telling students to “think about their thinking” without ever showing what that sounds like.	Students have a strategy name but cannot use it on their own.
6	AT selection: start simple and match the task	Choose assistive technology by matching the student, environment, and task (SETT), trying the simplest tool that works before high-tech options.	Picking the newest or most expensive device first.	A team is choosing among low-, mid-, and high-tech tools.
7	Text-to-speech gives access, not decoding practice	Text-to-speech lets a student reach grade-level content, but it bypasses decoding, so it supplements, never replaces, decoding instruction.	Using text-to-speech during the lesson meant to build the student’s word reading.	The goal named is decoding, but the proposed tool reads the words aloud.
8	Peer-assisted learning (PALS)	Structured, reciprocal peer tutoring with trained roles and scripts raises practice time for everyone in the class.	Pairing a strong reader with a struggling one and telling them to “help each other” with no roles or routine.	A teacher wants more practice turns for many students at once.

Course scope (public description): Elementary Literacy and Mathematics Strategies and Assistive Technologies prepares special education teachers to use progress monitoring and evidence-based instructional practices appropriate for elementary students with exceptionalities. The course includes cognitive and metacognitive strategies that elementary students can use to acquire new content knowledge and generalize skills across learning environments. It also provides opportunities for learners to incorporate intensive instructional strategies and practice making accommodations that include assistive technologies to elementary math and English

language arts lesson plans based on learner characteristics, performance data, and individualized education program (IEP) goals.